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DEMENTIA CARE RESEARCH AND PSYCHOSOCIAL FACTORS

POSTER PRESENTATION

DEMENTIA CARE RESEARCH

Perception of Quality of Life in patients with mild to moderate Dementia: A comparison between patients and caregivers evaluation

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Abstract

Background: "Quality of life" is defined as an individual's perception of their position in life according to cultural contexts and values. This concept represents one of the main priorities in the management of people living with dementia, modifying the perceived status of the disease, duration of care, neuropsychiatric symptoms, etc. Different questionnaires, applicable to patients and their caregivers, have been developed to assess quality of life. However, few studies compare the scores obtained between both of these subjects.

Method: A cross-sectional, observational, and comparative study was conducted on patients from the Cognitive Aging and Dementia Clinic diagnosed with Alzheimer's, Vascular, or Mixed dementia in mild or moderate stages and their caregivers. The study describes demographic variables and compares the scores obtained in the quality of life scales.

Result: We obtained 21 responses from patients (61.9% and 38.1% with mild and moderate stage dementia) and their caregivers. The group with mild dementia had a mean age of 77 years (62-90, $p = 0.332$), mostly female (47.6%, $p = 0.410$), and had mixed pathology (33.3%, $p = 0.023$). In the moderate dementia group, the mean age was 73 years (64-85, $p = 0.332$), also primarily female (23.8%, $p = 0.410$), and the most frequent diagnosis was Alzheimer's (28.5%, $p = 28.5\%$). The caregivers were mainly women, children, or spouses (42.8% and 52.5%, $p = 0.676$) and didn't have depression ($p = 0.590$). There were no significant differences in the total QoL-AD score (34.1 in patients vs. 33.8 in caregivers, $p = 0.880$), except for self-perception ($p = 0.029$) and economic status ($p = 0.015$), which were both higher for patients. Neither were

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there differences in the WHOQOL-Bref questionnaire (81.19 in patients vs. 78.2 in caregivers, $p = 0.502$).

Conclusion: Unlike previous studies, no significant differences were observed between the responses obtained from patients and caregivers when assessing quality of life. However, the scores for items related to self-perception and economic status differed. Extending the study to other dementia syndromes or other care centers could strengthen and broaden the present study's analysis.

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Sociodemographic characteristics of patients with mild to moderate dementia

		Mild Dementia (n = 13)	Moderate dementia (n= 8)	p value
Age - Mean (range)		77 (62-90)	73 (64-85)	0.332
Sex (%)	Female	47.6%	23.8%	0.410
	Male	14.3%	14.3%	
Educational level (%)	None	4.8%	14.3%	0.306
	Primary	28.6%	4.8%	
	Secondary	9.5%	4.8%	
	High school	9.5%	4.8%	
	Bachelor's degree or higher	9.5%	9.5%	
Marital status(%)	Single	33.3%	14.3%	0.445
	Married	19%	23.8%	
	Free union	4.8%	0%	
	Widow	4.8%	0%	
Type of Dementia (%)	Alzheimer´s	9.5%	28.5%	0.023
	Vascular	19%	4.8%	
	Mixed	33.3%	4.8%	
MMSE — Mean (range)		23.30 (19-28)	15.12 (11-18)	<0.001
Neuropsychiatric symptoms (%)	Depression	33.3%	23.8%	0.528
	Anxiety	33.3%	23.8%	0.528
	Irritability	28.6%	9.5%	0.310
	Agitation	33.3%	19%	0.608
Depression (GDS-15)	No depression	42.9%	28.6%	0.234
	Mild depression	4.8%	9.5%	
	Established depression	14.3%	0%	

Abbreviations. MMSE: Mini-Mental State Examination. GDS-15: Geriatric Depression Scale, 15-item version.

Sociodemographic characteristics of caregivers

		Mild Dementia (n = 13)	Moderate dementia (n= 8)	p value
Age - Mean (range)		59 (34-83)	58 (40-77)	0.926
Sex – (%)	Female	52.4%	28.6%	0.498
	Male	9.5%	9.5%	
Caregiver-Patient Relationship (%)	Children	23.8%	19%	0.676
	Spouse	33.3%	19%	
	Formal Caregiver	4.8%	0%	
Caregiver's education (%)	Primary	9.5%	14.3%	0.712
	Secondary	9.5%	4.8%	
	High School	19%	9.5%	
	Bachelor's degree or higher	23.8%	9.5%	
Hours of care		15.23	13.62	0.429
Depression (Hamilton)	No depression	28.6%	28.6%	0.590
	Mild depression	14.3%	4.8%	
	Depression	14.3%	4.8%	